

sustained growth.

What are the latest developments in infrastructure augmentation at Paradip Port—such as mechanization, terminal capacity, and multimodal logistics connectivity? How will these enhance turnaround times and operational efficiency?

Central to our expansion is the **Western Dock Project**, a 25 MTPA greenfield initiative with Cape-size vessel-enabled berths and 18.5m draft, slated for Phase I completion by 2026. This will enable handling of large vessels, reduce logistics costs, and open new trade avenues.

We are mechanizing four existing berths and constructing four new ones to boost throughput and efficiency. A dedicated **4 MTPA green berth** is being developed for green hydrogen and ammonia exports, aligning with India's sustainability goals. Connectivity upgrades include a **2.4 km flyover-cum-road** to ease traffic, contribution to the 8-laning of NH-53, and enhanced rail sidings capable of handling over 100 rakes daily for seamless cargo movement.

Together, these will reduce vessel turnaround and dwell times, diversify cargo types, and cement Paradip's role as a high-performance multimodal logistics hub.

Sustainability is increasingly a core focus. What steps has Paradip Port taken toward becoming a green and smart port? Any flagship ESG projects you'd like to highlight?

We are committed to building a cleaner, smarter, and sustainable port ecosystem. Our target is **100% mechanized cargo handling by 2030** (up from 80%), utilizing covered conveyors, enclosed zones, and advanced equipment to minimize dust and noise pollution.

A **10 MW solar plant** is under development, to be commissioned by March 2026, with plans to source 60% of power from renewables and the rest via green open access, aiming to become a fully solar-powered port by 2030.

Marine operations are transitioning to **hybrid and green tugs** under our Green Tug Transition Program, with shore power extended to vessels at coal berths to significantly reduce emissions.

Our **zero liquid discharge sewage plants**

and integrated solid waste management systems ensure eco-friendly waste treatment.

How critical has multi-stakeholder coordination been to Paradip Port's recent achievements? What mechanisms are in place to ensure continued alignment?

Collaboration has been pivotal. Seamless coordination among terminal operators, shipping lines, cargo aggregators, Indian Railways, Customs, and government bodies has enabled smooth, uninterrupted operations and fast clearances even during peak demand.

To sustain this, we've institutionalized regular stakeholder consultations, digital information-sharing platforms, and integrated planning. Our active participation in **PM Gati Shakti** initiatives reinforces Paradip's role as a multimodal logistics hub aligned with national corridors.

These frameworks strengthen partnerships, unlock new collaborations, and position Paradip as a cost-efficient, well-connected gateway.

Paradip Port recently signed MoUs with the Government of Odisha for Bahuda Port and a shipbuilding hub at Mahanadi mouth. What do these mean for the east coast, and what are the next steps?

At the PM's event in Bhavnagar, Paradip Port signed two MoUs totaling ₹46,200 crore with Odisha, marking a transformative boost to India's maritime and shipbuilding capabilities.

The **Bahuda Major Port** is a greenfield 150 MTPA deep-draft port with ₹21,500 crore investment, set to become India's 14th major port and a new gateway for trade.

The **shipbuilding and repair hub** at Mahanadi mouth, with ₹24,700 crore

investment, will be a strategic manufacturing and maintenance base aligned with national shipbuilding and recycling goals.

These projects will catalyze industrial ecosystems, vendor and skill development, and ease congestion at existing ports.

Next steps include forming joint working groups, project structuring, DPR and statutory clearances, multimodal connectivity plans under PM Gati Shakti, and PPP frameworks to accelerate early execution and attract private investment.

Indian Maritime Week 2025 is approaching. What can the industry expect, and how are preparations shaping up?

Indian Maritime Week 2025, scheduled in Mumbai from 27–31 October, will be among the largest global maritime forums, convening over 100 nations, 200 speakers, 500 exhibitors, and 100,000 delegates.

It's designed for leaders to converge, converse, coordinate, and co-create the maritime future. Key themes include port modernization, capacity augmentation, green shipping, shipbuilding, maritime finance, and security. Odisha and all maritime states will actively participate.

The Ministry targets MoUs worth over ₹10 lakh crore, with Paradip Port expected to attract over ₹1 lakh crore — nearly a tenth of total investments — underscoring its vital role in India's maritime growth.

